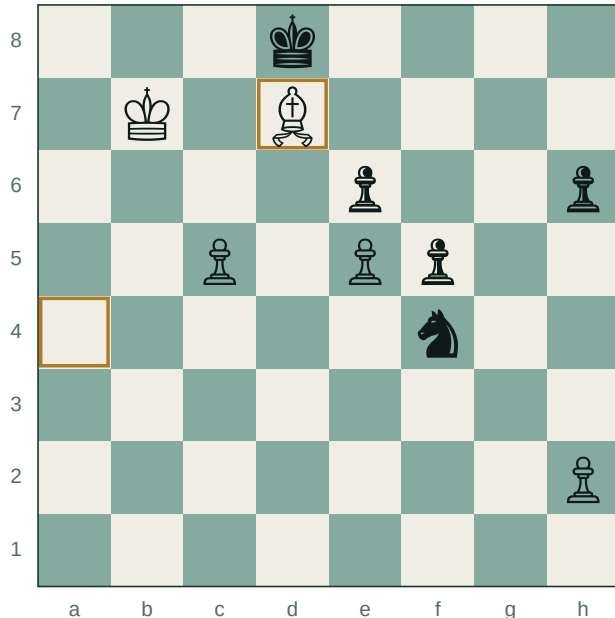


Active defensive resources: Black, move 51

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Bxd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51...Nd3 52. Bb5 Nxc5+ 53. Kc6 Ne4

51...Nd3 The knight moves from f4 to d3. Recorded reply: **52.Bb5**.

52...Nxc5+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on c5. Recorded reply: **53.Kc6**.

53...Ne4 The knight moves from c5 to e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d7. Check for tactical protection.